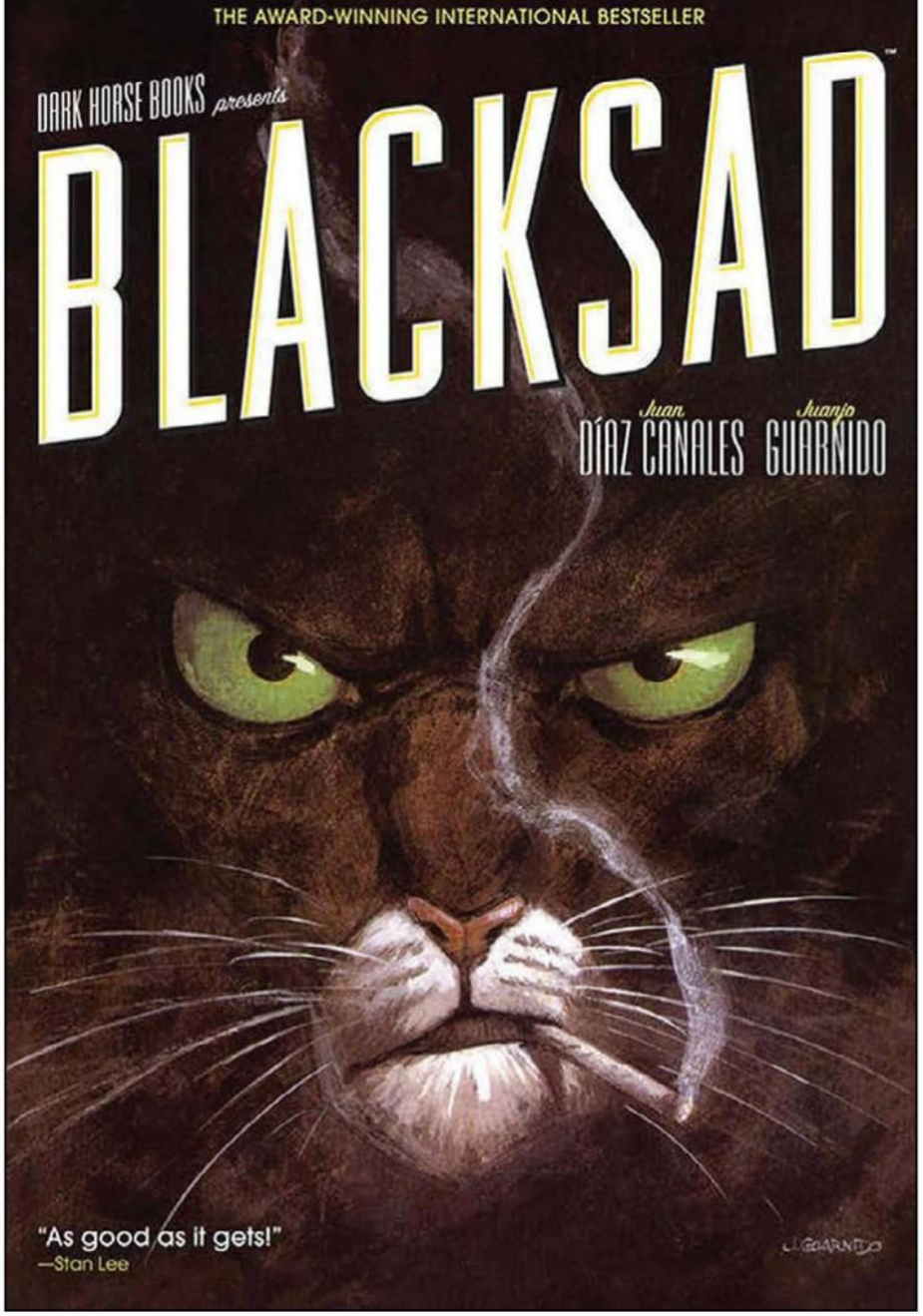


BLACKSAD

Details **Originally published** Blacksad: Quelque part entre les ombres (2000) **Publisher** Dargaud, Dark Horse **Writer** Juan Díaz Canales **Artist** Juanjo Guarnido **Collected in** Blacksad **Available digitally** Dark Horse Digital, Kindle

One of the crowning jewels of the large French bande dessinée market, *Blacksad* is easily one of the most beautiful comics ever created. English readers had to wait years for the first three volumes to be collected in one glorious book by Dark Horse, but the publisher has long since caught up, with volume five out in 2014.

The film noir style comic is set in Fifties America, with a cast of anthropomorphic animals that exploits stereotypes and points to character personalities. Blacksad himself is a hardboiled PI, investigating crimes while narrating proceedings. His cynicism is balanced by the chirpiness of his occasional sidekick, Weekly, a muckraking journalist for a tabloid newspaper.

With rat goons, a goanna hitman, a racist polar bear, and a nuclear physicist who also happens to be an owl, the gritty realism of *Blacksad* is perhaps a surprise to many. The stunning collection of the first three volumes is worth every penny.

"THE GRITTY REALISM IS PERHAPS SURPRISING TO MANY"

